IMPORTANT SURVEY DEFINITIONS AND SERVICE DESCRIPTIONS

THE 2026 NATIONAL SURVEY OF COMMUNITY REHABILITATION PROVIDERS

Intellectual and Developmental Disabilities (IDD)

Intellectual and developmental disabilities (IDD)[1] is a term used to describe a group that includes either:

- people with both intellectual disability ***and*** another developmental disability, or
- people with intellectual disability ***or*** another developmental disability

Intellectual disability refers to significant limitations in both intellectual functioning (such as reasoning, learning, and problem-solving) and adaptive behavior, which includes everyday social and practical skills.

Developmental disability is an umbrella term that includes intellectual disability and other related conditions. It is generally defined as:

- a severe, chronic disability attributable to a mental and/or physical impairment
- originating before age 22
- likely to continue indefinitely
- resulting in substantial limitations in at least three major life activities

It may include:

- neurological disabilities (e.g., autism, epilepsy, spina bifida, traumatic brain injury)
- physical disabilities (e.g., cerebral palsy, muscular dystrophy, multiple sclerosis).

Employment & Day Services

Employment services are services provided to individuals with disabilities to support them in obtaining and maintaining paid employment.

Day services are services in which individuals with disabilities are not paid for work and are not required to actively seek paid employment.

People may receive day services when they are not receiving employment services. Day services may include structured activities or supports during non-work time (when an individual is not working).

Depending on state definitions, employment-related activities may be included within day services to support an individual's employment pathway; however, the primary purpose of day services is **not employment outcomes**.

People can receive both service types in **community-based** or **facility-based settings.**

[1] www.AAIDD.org

Employment Services (Work Services)

Community-Based

Individual Integrated Employment

Support to obtain, maintain, or advance in a job in the general labor market through time-limited and/or ongoing job supports. This includes customized employment.

- **Service Outcome:** The individual is competitively employed in an integrated job that pays at least minimum wage in a workplace where the majority of coworkers do not have disabilities. This includes **self-employment/ entrepreneurism.**

Group Supported Employment

Support to work in group-based integrated jobs in community businesses and workplaces for up to eight workers with disabilities. Services are provided in regular community and business settings and may include enclaves and mobile crews.

  - » **Enclaves:** Groups of up to eight employees with disabilities work together at a community employer's worksite, where most workers do not have disabilities, and receive ongoing job-related supports.
  - » **Mobile crews:** Groups of up to eight employees with disabilities move between multiple community employer worksites, where most workers do not have disabilities, and receive ongoing job-related supports.
- **Service Outcome:** The individual is employed in a group-based integrated job that may pay below, at, or above minimum wage in a business where the majority of coworkers do not have disabilities.

Facility-Based

Support to work in a provider-operated facility or business, including **sheltered workshops**, where most people served or employed have disabilities.

- **Service Outcome:** The individual performs paid work in a facility-based setting, where most people served or employed have disabilities, and wages may be below minimum wage.

Day Services (Non-Work Services)

Community-Based

Services in which individuals spend more than 50% of service time in integrated community environments, where most individuals do not have disabilities.

Service activities may include supporting individuals to increase community participation, including:

- volunteer experiences
- recreation and leisure activities
- skill development (e.g., social, adaptive, communication skills)
- educational or exploratory activities
- activities of daily living

Facility-Based

Services in which individuals spend more than 50% of service time in provider-operated or provider-controlled facility settings, where most individuals served have disabilities.

Service activities may include:

- recreation and leisure activities
- skill development (e.g., social, adaptive, communication skills)
- professional therapies (e.g., occupational therapy, physical therapy, speech therapy)
- activities of daily living

This category includes **day habilitation, medical day services/medical day care, and day activity programs.**